

Exploring the usage of project management practices among digital research technical professionals (dRTPs) at the University of Sheffield - Part 1

What is the purpose of the study?

The purpose of this study is to explore the usage of project management practices among individuals who categorise themselves as digital research technical professionals (dRTPs)

Do I have to take part?

No, participation is entirely voluntary.

You can withdraw at any time before completing the questionnaire by exiting the webpage. The questionnaire can be completed completely anonymously, and if you do so then you will not be able to withdraw your responses once it has been completed. If you complete the questionnaire and opt-in to future research by including your name and email address then you can withdraw your responses until 01/08/2026

What would taking part involve?

You will be asked to complete a questionnaire exploring your experiences of using project management strategies. The questionnaire will begin by asking about the type of projects you undertake as a dRTP. It will then explore the type of practices or strategies you use, if any, to manage different aspects of these projects. Finally you will be asked some demographic questions. All questions are optional and completing this questionnaire should take you no more than 30 minutes

Who is organising and funding the research?

The research has been organised by Dr Daniel Brady, and has been funded by a DisCouRSE grant (a UKRI-funded Network+ project)

Are there any risks in taking part?

Beyond the time spent completing the questionnaire, there are no risks

anticipated from your participation.

What are the possible benefits of taking part?

There are no intended personal benefits to taking part. The broader benefits of the project are to enhance our understanding of the types of project management strategies in use by dRTPs, which will then be used to inform training materials for future dRTPs.

Will my taking part in this project be kept confidential?

All your personal data will be kept strictly confidential and will only be accessible to members of the research team. The information you provide may be used in publications, reports, web pages, and other research outputs but you will not be named in these outputs.

Data Protection

Data will be collected using this Google form and the data collected will be stored on the University of Sheffield's secure, Multi-Factor Authenticated (MFA) Google Drive.

Raw data will be stored until an initial analysis and follow up study have been conducted, and it is expected that it will be kept no later than 31/12/2026.

The questionnaire can be submitted anonymously, in which case no identifiable information linked to you will be recorded. It can also be submitted while opting in for future research, in which case personal information (Name and Email) will be linked to the collected data but will be moved to a separate, password protected file. This information will be destroyed for all participants after the follow-up study has been conducted regardless of whether they participated or not.

Data collected as part of this study will be used in two ways. Firstly it will be analysed as part of the primary aim of the project (exploring project management strategies used by dRTPs). Secondly, where participants have opted into future research it will be used to select which participants are asked to participate in that research.

The data collected as part of this study will be made openly available by depositing it in ORDA (the University of Sheffield data repository). Information that could potentially be used to identify individual respondents will be removed from the deposited dataset, this includes: Role type, Seniority, Gender identity, and Ethnicity.

This research is carried out 'in the public interest' in accordance with data protection legislation. Further information can be found in the University's Privacy Notice.

Some of your data collected during the research is defined in the legislation as more sensitive (information about your ethnicity), so we need to let you know that the use of this data is necessary 'for archiving purposes in the public interest, scientific research purposes or statistical purposes'

The University of Sheffield will act as the Data Controller for this study. This means that the University is responsible for looking after your information and using it properly.

Participation in future research:

The questionnaire will include a final question allowing you to opt into future research on the topic. Opting-in is entirely voluntary and you will not be obligated to participate in any future research if you change your mind.

Ethics approval:

This project has received ethical approval by School of Computer Science at the University of Sheffield: Application reference 073270

What if something goes wrong and I wish to complain about the research or report a concern or incident?

If you would like to complain about any aspect of the research or if you feel that you have been exploited, abused or harmed as a result of taking part in the research, please contact Daniel Brady (daniel.brady@sheffield.ac.uk).

If you feel your complaint has not been handled in a satisfactory way you can contact the Head of the School of Computer Science Professor Heidi Christensen (heidi.christensen@sheffield.ac.uk). If your complaint is about how your personal data has been handled, you can find information about how to raise a complaint in the University's Privacy Notice.

Contact for further information

If you would like further information about this study please contact Daniel Brady (daniel.brady@sheffield.ac.uk)

Thank you for considering taking part in this study

* Indicates required question

Consent Form

Please read the consent form sections below

1. Taking part in the project *

1. I have read and understood the project information sheet dated 15/04/2026 or the project has been fully explained to me.
(If you will answer No to this question please do not proceed with this consent form until you are fully aware of what taking part in the project will mean.)
2. I have been given the opportunity to ask questions about the project.
3. I understand how to raise a concern or make a complaint.
4. I agree to take part in the project. I understand that taking part in the project will include completing a questionnaire.
5. I understand that by choosing to participate as a volunteer in this research, this does not create a legally binding agreement nor is it intended to create an employment relationship with the University of Sheffield.
6. I understand that I can complete this survey completely anonymously and in doing so I will not be able to withdraw my responses after submission
7. I understand that I can opt-in to future research, and that in doing so my responses will not be anonymous and that I will be able to withdraw my responses until 01/08/2026.

Tick all that apply.

☐ I understand and agree to the above

2. How my information will be used during and after the project *

1. I understand that my personal details will not be revealed to people outside the project.
2. I understand and agree that my words may be quoted in publications, reports, web pages, and other research outputs. I understand that I will not be named in these outputs.
3. I understand and agree that other authorised researchers may be given access to my anonymised data.
4. I understand and agree that other authorised researchers may use my anonymised data in publications, reports, web pages, and other research outputs.

Tick all that apply.

☐ I understand and agree to the above

3. So that the information you provide can be deposited in a data repository *

1. I give permission for the questionnaire responses that I provide to be deposited in ORDA (the University of Sheffield data repository)
2. I agree to assign the copyright I hold in any materials generated as part of this project to The University of Sheffield.

Tick all that apply.

☐ I understand and agree to the above

Your working context

4. **How many projects have you been involved in a dRTP capacity?**

Over the last 18 Months

5. **On average how many projects have you been working on simultaneously?**

Over the last 18 Months

6. **On average how long have your recent projects lasted, in months?**

Over the last 18 Months

7. **Including yourself, what is the approximate average team size for these projects?**

This includes anyone regularly contributing to the project, e.g. academics, other RTPs, students, external stakeholders, etc

8. **Approximately, on average how many other team members were also dRTPs?**
-

9. **Approximately how many of these projects had a dedicated project management professional involved regularly?**

This includes: Project managers, Business Analysts, etc

10. **How many of these projects had existing project management strategies that you had to adopt/adapt to?**
-

Your practices

The following section will ask about specific practices and strategies that you use to manage different aspect of projects.

These are broadly defined into 9 categories, though be aware that there may be some overlap in these categories and the listed practices/strategies may feel like they fit better elsewhere to you. Please answer as best you can. You will be able to go back and adjust your responses until you submit them.

The 9 categories are:

1. Requirements Gathering

This involves identifying the specific goals and practical needs of a project before the hands-on work begins. It focuses on taking broad ideas and turning them into a clear list of what actually needs to be built or achieved.

2. Scope Management

This focuses on defining the specific limits of a project and identifying which tasks are excluded from the work. It also involves the process of evaluating new requests and adapting the original plan when circumstances shift unexpectedly.

3. Task Planning

This involves taking a project and dividing it into smaller individual tasks. It focuses on how these pieces of work are organized so they can be assigned and tracked through to completion.

4. Timeline Management

This focuses on scheduling individual tasks and setting target dates for the work. It involves mapping out a realistic schedule to ensure that different phases coordinate properly with major project milestones.

5. Progress Reporting

This is the practice of sharing regular updates about the current status of your work. It provides visibility to others regarding which tasks are finished, what is currently being worked on, and what is coming next.

6. Collaboration Management

This covers how you interact with the people who have a direct interest in your work, such as project leads, collaborators, or end-users. It involves keeping them updated and ensuring everyone agrees on the project's goals and overall direction.

7. Risk Management

This involves identifying potential problems, technical hurdles, or delays that could impact the work. It also includes preparing alternative plans and responses to address these issues if they actually occur.

8. Project Knowledge Management

This focuses on the continuous accumulation and organization of project knowledge, including context, decisions, methods, code, and data. The aim is to create an accessible history that enables others to effectively understand, reproduce, and engage with the work at any stage.

9. Project Wrap-up and Review

This involves finishing up a completed project or major milestone and looking back at how the work went. It focuses on taking care of final closing tasks, and figuring out how to improve your team's workflow for next time.

1. Requirements Gathering

This involves identifying the specific goals and practical needs of a project before the hands-on work begins. It focuses on taking broad ideas and turning them into a clear list of what actually needs to be built or achieved.

11. **How frequently is Requirements Gathering a necessary part of your typical project workflow?**

 Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Frequently
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

12. **In your view, how significant are the consequences for project outcomes when Requirements Gathering is not addressed?**

⌵ Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Critical - Total failure; primary goals become impossible to achieve.
- ☐ Major - Severe disruptions requiring significant rework or loss of features.
- ☐ Moderate - Noticeable issues requiring specific fixes or causing minor delays.
- ☐ Minor - Small inconveniences easily managed without impacting the final outcome.
- ☐ Negligible - Barely any impact; no measurable effect on the project.

13. **When this aspect arises, which best describes your typical approach?**

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Structured - I use specific strategies or frameworks
- ☐ Ad-hoc - I handle it informally on a case-by-case basis without specific strategies
- ☐ Not Managed - I do not currently address or manage this aspect.

14. If you responded "Structured":

Which specific strategies for Requirements Gathering do you currently use?

Strategy definitions

Select all that apply, if you use strategies not listed here include them in the "other" section

Tick all that apply.

- ☐ User Stories
- ☐ Stakeholder Interviews
- ☐ Brainstorming
- ☐ Mind mapping
- ☐ Document/Codebase Analysis
- ☐ Observation
- ☐ Prototyping
- ☐ Other: _____

15. If you responded "Ad-hoc" or "Not Managed":

Have you used a specific, structured strategy for this aspect in the past?

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes

☐ No

16. If you responded "Ad-hoc" or "Not Managed":
**Would you be open to adopting a structured strategy/
approach for this in the future?**

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not Sure

2. Scope Management

This focuses on defining the specific limits of a project and identifying which tasks are excluded from the work. It also involves the process of evaluating new requests and adapting the original plan when circumstances shift unexpectedly.

17. **How frequently is Scope Management a necessary
part of your typical project workflow?**  Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Frequently
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

18. **In your view, how significant are the consequences for project outcomes when Scope Management is not addressed?**  Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Critical - Total failure; primary goals become impossible to achieve.
- ☐ Major - Severe disruptions requiring significant rework or loss of features.
- ☐ Moderate - Noticeable issues requiring specific fixes or causing minor delays.
- ☐ Minor - Small inconveniences easily managed without impacting the final outcome.
- ☐ Negligible - Barely any impact; no measurable effect on the project.

19. **When this aspect arises, which best describes your typical approach?**

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Structured - I use specific strategies or frameworks
- ☐ Ad-hoc - I handle it informally on a case-by-case basis without specific strategies
- ☐ Not Managed - I do not currently address or manage this aspect.

20. If you responded "Structured":
Which specific strategies for Scope Management do you currently use?

Strategy definitions

Select all that apply, if you use strategies not listed here include them in the "other" section

Tick all that apply.

- ☐ MoSCoW Prioritization
- ☐ The 100-Dollar Test
- ☐ SMART Goals
- ☐ Minimum Viable Product (MVP) Definition
- ☐ Scope Definition
- ☐ Completion Criteria
- ☐ Scope Relationship Diagrams
- ☐ Scope verification
- ☐ Change Impact Analysis
- ☐ Change Log
- ☐ Other: _____

21. If you responded "Ad-hoc" or "Not Managed":
Have you used a specific, structured strategy for this aspect in the past?

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes

☐ No

22. If you responded "Ad-hoc" or "Not Managed":
**Would you be open to adopting a structured strategy/
approach for this in the future?**

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not Sure

3. Task Planning

This involves taking a project and dividing it into smaller individual tasks. It focuses on how these pieces of work are organised so they can be assigned and tracked through to completion.

23. **How frequently is Task Planning a necessary part
of your typical project workflow?**

 Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Frequently
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

24. **In your view, how significant are the consequences for project outcomes when Task Planning is not addressed?**  Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Critical - Total failure; primary goals become impossible to achieve.
- ☐ Major - Severe disruptions requiring significant rework or loss of features.
- ☐ Moderate - Noticeable issues requiring specific fixes or causing minor delays.
- ☐ Minor - Small inconveniences easily managed without impacting the final outcome.
- ☐ Negligible - Barely any impact; no measurable effect on the project.

25. **When this aspect arises, which best describes your typical approach?**

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Structured - I use specific strategies or frameworks
- ☐ Ad-hoc - I handle it informally on a case-by-case basis without specific strategies
- ☐ Not Managed - I do not currently address or manage this aspect.

26. If you responded "Structured":
Which specific strategies for Task Planning do you currently use?

Strategy definitions

Select all that apply, if you use strategies not listed here include them in the "other" section

Tick all that apply.

- ☐ Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)
- ☐ Work Package definitions
- ☐ Agile Backlog Management (Epics, Backlogs, & Sprint Planning)
- ☐ Task Dependency Mapping
- ☐ Bucket size planning
- ☐ Planning poker
- ☐ Eisenhower Matrix
- ☐ Requirement Traceability Matrix
- ☐ Other: _____

27. If you responded "Ad-hoc" or "Not Managed":
Have you used a specific, structured strategy for this aspect in the past?

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

28. If you responded "Ad-hoc" or "Not Managed":
**Would you be open to adopting a structured strategy/
approach for this in the future?**

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not Sure

4. Timeline Management

This focuses on scheduling individual tasks and setting target dates for the work. It involves mapping out a realistic schedule to ensure that different phases coordinate properly with major project milestones.

29. **How frequently is Timeline Management a
necessary part of your typical project workflow?**

 Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Frequently
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

30. **In your view, how significant are the consequences for project outcomes when Timeline Management is not addressed?** Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Critical - Total failure; primary goals become impossible to achieve.
- ☐ Major - Severe disruptions requiring significant rework or loss of features.
- ☐ Moderate - Noticeable issues requiring specific fixes or causing minor delays.
- ☐ Minor - Small inconveniences easily managed without impacting the final outcome.
- ☐ Negligible - Barely any impact; no measurable effect on the project.

31. **When this aspect arises, which best describes your typical approach?**

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Structured - I use specific strategies or frameworks
- ☐ Ad-hoc - I handle it informally on a case-by-case basis without specific strategies
- ☐ Not Managed - I do not currently address or manage this aspect.

32. If you responded "Structured":
Which specific strategies for Timeline Management do you currently use?

Strategy definitions

Select all that apply, if you use strategies not listed here include them in the "other" section

Tick all that apply.

- ☐ Gantt Chart
- ☐ Backward Mapping (Reverse Scheduling)
- ☐ Roadmaps
- ☐ Swimlane timelines
- ☐ Kanban timelines
- ☐ Critical path method
- ☐ PERT (Program Evaluation and Review Technique) Chart
- ☐ Other: _____

33. If you responded "Ad-hoc" or "Not Managed":
Have you used a specific, structured strategy for this aspect in the past?

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

34. If you responded "Ad-hoc" or "Not Managed":
**Would you be open to adopting a structured strategy/
approach for this in the future?**

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not Sure

5. Progress Reporting

This is the practice of sharing regular updates about the current status of your work. It provides visibility to others regarding which tasks are finished, what is currently being worked on, and what is coming next.

35. **How frequently is Progress Reporting a necessary
part of your typical project workflow?**  Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Frequently
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

36. **In your view, how significant are the consequences for project outcomes when Progress Reporting is not addressed?**  Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Critical - Total failure; primary goals become impossible to achieve.
- ☐ Major - Severe disruptions requiring significant rework or loss of features.
- ☐ Moderate - Noticeable issues requiring specific fixes or causing minor delays.
- ☐ Minor - Small inconveniences easily managed without impacting the final outcome.
- ☐ Negligible - Barely any impact; no measurable effect on the project.

37. **When this aspect arises, which best describes your typical approach?**

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Structured - I use specific strategies or frameworks
- ☐ Ad-hoc - I handle it informally on a case-by-case basis without specific strategies
- ☐ Not Managed - I do not currently address or manage this aspect.

38. If you responded "Structured":
Which specific strategies for Progress Reporting do you currently use?

Strategy definitions

Select all that apply, if you use strategies not listed here include them in the "other" section

Tick all that apply.

- ☐ Project status reports
- ☐ Asynchronous Check-ins
- ☐ Stand-ups
- ☐ Progress review meetings
- ☐ RAG Status (Red-Amber-Green)
- ☐ Kanban Board
- ☐ Project Dashboard
- ☐ Burndown chart
- ☐ Other: _____

39. If you responded "Ad-hoc" or "Not Managed":
Have you used a specific, structured strategy for this aspect in the past?

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

40. If you responded "Ad-hoc" or "Not Managed":
**Would you be open to adopting a structured strategy/
approach for this in the future?**

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not Sure

6. Collaboration Management

This covers how you interact with the people who have a direct interest in your work, such as project leads, collaborators, or end-users. It involves keeping them updated and ensuring everyone agrees on the project's goals and overall direction.

41. **How frequently is Collaboration Management a
necessary part of your typical project workflow?**

 Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Frequently
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

42. **In your view, how significant are the consequences for project outcomes when Collaboration Management is not addressed?**

⌵ Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Critical - Total failure; primary goals become impossible to achieve.
- ☐ Major - Severe disruptions requiring significant rework or loss of features.
- ☐ Moderate - Noticeable issues requiring specific fixes or causing minor delays.
- ☐ Minor - Small inconveniences easily managed without impacting the final outcome.
- ☐ Negligible - Barely any impact; no measurable effect on the project.

43. **When this aspect arises, which best describes your typical approach?**

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Structured - I use specific strategies or frameworks
- ☐ Ad-hoc - I handle it informally on a case-by-case basis without specific strategies
- ☐ Not Managed - I do not currently address or manage this aspect.

44. If you responded "Structured":
Which specific strategies for Collaboration Management do you currently use?

Strategy definitions

Select all that apply, if you use strategies not listed here include them in the "other" section

Tick all that apply.

- ☐ Meeting minutes
- ☐ Roles and Responsibilities Charter
- ☐ Communication Plan/Agreement
- ☐ Stakeholder Map
- ☐ Working Agreements (Team Charters)
- ☐ Other: _____

45. If you responded "Ad-hoc" or "Not Managed":
Have you used a specific, structured strategy for this aspect in the past?

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

46. If you responded "Ad-hoc" or "Not Managed":
Would you be open to adopting a structured strategy/ approach for this in the future?

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not Sure

7. Risk Management

This involves identifying potential problems, technical hurdles, or delays that could impact the work. It also includes preparing alternative plans and responses to address these issues if they actually occur.

47. **How frequently is Risk Management a necessary part of your typical project workflow?**  Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Frequently
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

48. **In your view, how significant are the consequences for project outcomes when Risk Management is not addressed?**  Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Critical - Total failure; primary goals become impossible to achieve.
- ☐ Major - Severe disruptions requiring significant rework or loss of features.
- ☐ Moderate - Noticeable issues requiring specific fixes or causing minor delays.
- ☐ Minor - Small inconveniences easily managed without impacting the final outcome.
- ☐ Negligible - Barely any impact; no measurable effect on the project.

49. **When this aspect arises, which best describes your typical approach?**

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Structured - I use specific strategies or frameworks
- ☐ Ad-hoc - I handle it informally on a case-by-case basis without specific strategies
- ☐ Not Managed - I do not currently address or manage this aspect.

50. If you responded "Structured":
Which specific strategies for Risk Management do you currently use?

[Strategy definitions](#)

Select all that apply, if you use strategies not listed here include them in the "other" section

Tick all that apply.

- ☐ RAID Log (Risks, Assumptions, Issues, Dependencies)
- ☐ Risk Register/Log
- ☐ Risk Statements
- ☐ Risk Matrix
- ☐ Mind-mapping risks
- ☐ SWOT (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats) risk analysis
- ☐ PESTLE (Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Legal, Environmental) risk analysis
- ☐ Bow-tie risk analysis
- ☐ Risk Mitigation/Contingency Plan
- ☐ Project Pre-Mortem
- ☐ Other: _____

51. If you responded "Ad-hoc" or "Not Managed":
Have you used a specific, structured strategy for this aspect in the past?

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes

☐ No

52. If you responded "Ad-hoc" or "Not Managed":
Would you be open to adopting a structured strategy/ approach for this in the future?

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Not Sure

8. Project Knowledge Management

This focuses on the continuous accumulation and organisation of project knowledge, including context, decisions, methods, code, and data. The aim is to create an accessible history that enables others to effectively understand, reproduce, and engage with the work at any stage.

53. **How frequently is Project Knowledge Management a necessary part of your typical project workflow?**  Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Frequently
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

54. **In your view, how significant are the consequences for project outcomes when Project Knowledge Management is not addressed?**  Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Critical - Total failure; primary goals become impossible to achieve.
- ☐ Major - Severe disruptions requiring significant rework or loss of features.
- ☐ Moderate - Noticeable issues requiring specific fixes or causing minor delays.
- ☐ Minor - Small inconveniences easily managed without impacting the final outcome.
- ☐ Negligible - Barely any impact; no measurable effect on the project.

55. **When this aspect arises, which best describes your typical approach?**

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Structured - I use specific strategies or frameworks
- ☐ Ad-hoc - I handle it informally on a case-by-case basis without specific strategies
- ☐ Not Managed - I do not currently address or manage this aspect.

56. If you responded "Structured":
Which specific strategies for Project Knowledge Management do you currently use?

[Strategy definitions](#)

Select all that apply, if you use strategies not listed here include them in the "other" section

Tick all that apply.

- ☐ Wikis
- ☐ Project Logs (Changelogs)
- ☐ Commit-driven documentation
- ☐ Readme Files
- ☐ Architecture Decision Records (ADR)
- ☐ Docstrings and Code Comments
- ☐ Contribution Guidelines
- ☐ Other: _____

57. If you responded "Ad-hoc" or "Not Managed":
Have you used a specific, structured strategy for this aspect in the past?

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

58. If you responded "Ad-hoc" or "Not Managed":
**Would you be open to adopting a structured strategy/
approach for this in the future?**

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not Sure

9. Project Review and Wrap-up

This involves finishing up a completed project or major milestone and looking back at how the work went. It focuses on taking care of final closing tasks, and figuring out how to improve your team's workflow for next time.

59. **How frequently is Project Review and Wrap-up a
necessary part of your typical project workflow?**

 Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Frequently
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

60. **In your view, how significant are the consequences for project outcomes when Project Review and Wrap-up is not addressed?**  Dropdown

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Critical - Total failure; primary goals become impossible to achieve.
- ☐ Major - Severe disruptions requiring significant rework or loss of features.
- ☐ Moderate - Noticeable issues requiring specific fixes or causing minor delays.
- ☐ Minor - Small inconveniences easily managed without impacting the final outcome.
- ☐ Negligible - Barely any impact; no measurable effect on the project.

61. **When this aspect arises, which best describes your typical approach?**

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Structured - I use specific strategies or frameworks
- ☐ Ad-hoc - I handle it informally on a case-by-case basis without specific strategies
- ☐ Not Managed - I do not currently address or manage this aspect.

62. If you responded "Structured":
Which specific strategies for Project Review and Wrap-up do you currently use?

Strategy definitions

Select all that apply, if you use strategies not listed here include them in the "other" section

Tick all that apply.

- ☐ Project Closure Checklist
- ☐ Project Closure Report
- ☐ Root Cause Analysis (The 5 Whys)
- ☐ Post-Mortem Meeting/Retrospective
- ☐ Within-Project Retrospectives
- ☐ Approval decision gates
- ☐ Other: _____

63. If you responded "Ad-hoc" or "Not Managed":
Have you used a specific, structured strategy for this aspect in the past?

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

64. If you responded "Ad-hoc" or "Not Managed":
Would you be open to adopting a structured strategy/approach for this in the future?

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not Sure

About you

65. **How many years have you been working primarily as a dRTP?**

66. **Are you in a senior or leadership role?**

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes

☐ No

67. Which role below most closely describes your current role?

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Bioinformatician or Computational Scientist
- ☐ Data Engineer
- ☐ Data Scientist, Analyst, AI or Machine Learning Specialist
- ☐ Data Steward or Data Manager
- ☐ DevOps Engineer or Cloud Architect
- ☐ Digital Humanities Technologist
- ☐ Digital Librarian or Archivist
- ☐ HPC or Research Computing Specialist
- ☐ MLOps Engineer
- ☐ Project or Community Manager/Coordinator
- ☐ Research Computing Facilitator
- ☐ Research Infrastructure Engineer
- ☐ Research Software Engineer
- ☐ Software Maintainer or Open-Source Contributor
- ☐ Technical Research Support Officer
- ☐ Other:

68. **Are you working in a centralised team or as an embedded dRTP?**

Typically:

- *Centralised teams consist of just dRTPs and undertake work across multiple domains.*
- *Embedded dRTPs work on a single project or within a single domain, within a mixed team of dRTPs and academics.*

Mark only one oval.

☐ Centralised

☐ Embedded

69. **Which of the following most accurately describes your gender identity?**

Mark only one oval.

☐ Male

☐ Female

☐ Non-binary

☐ Prefer to self describe, please describe below

☐ Prefer not to say

70. **If you responded "*Prefer to self describe*" in the previous question, describe your gender identity here.**

71. What is your ethnic group?

Choose one option that best describes your ethnic group or background

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ English / Welsh / Scottish / Northern Irish / British
- ☐ Irish
- ☐ Gypsy or Irish Traveller
- ☐ Any other White background, please describe below
- ☐ White and Black Caribbean
- ☐ White and Black African
- ☐ White and Asian
- ☐ Any other Mixed / Multiple ethnic background, please describe below
- ☐ Indian
- ☐ Pakistani
- ☐ Bangladeshi
- ☐ Chinese
- ☐ Any other Asian background, please describe below
- ☐ African
- ☐ Caribbean
- ☐ Any other Black / African / Caribbean background, please describe below
- ☐ Arab
- ☐ Any other ethnic group, please describe below

72. If you selected any of the "*Other*" categories above, please describe your ethic group here

Future research

This survey will be followed up in the future with a number of focus groups, in order to explore project management practices among dRTPs in a bit more depth.

If you would like to participate in future research please add your name and email address below

73. Your Name

74. Your Email

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